

Be a Competitor: Wrap-Up, Featuring Roberto Fernandez

Roberto Fernandez, Medical Director, The Pat Summitt Clinic at The University of Tennessee Medical Center

Coach Summitt believed being a competitor meant that you were willing to do whatever it took to get things done. No job was too big or too little. You were either all in, or you'd be left out. For Pat, the payoff was worth it. She said, "Competitiveness is not meant for peacetime, but it is an invaluable quality in coping with misfortune. Channeled correctly, you can use it to battle all sorts of hardship in your life, not just the athletic kind, or the corporate kind, or the managerial kind."

In this module, you learned what it takes to be a competitor and how to use competitiveness as your advantage in difficult situations. First, you saw that true competitors are tough and set high goals. Pleasing others shouldn't be the primary motivation. Competitors need to be assertive and proactive in their pursuit of success. They must be willing to embrace new challenges and stretch their limits. This is the only way to avoid the seductive comforts of being average or an underachiever.

Next, competitors win battles by influencing their opponents. Force opponents to take unexpected detours from their strengths by knowing their tendencies and using that knowledge to make them rely on their weaknesses. Devote yourself to the hustle as you study your competitors and expose their deficiencies. When you influence your opponents, you rely on effort to outwork the opposing talent.

Finally, competitors love their adversaries. They are not frightened by intense opposition. Instead, they embrace the challenge and use it as an opportunity for improvement. Strong competition demands your best and helps you achieve your best. Be grateful for opponents and take them seriously. This is how competitors stay hungry for success.

Pat Summitt used competitiveness to get through adversity and achieve the extraordinary. When you choose to be a competitor, you unlock the potential for success, and you train your mind to persevere through every challenge. Pat said, "Competition trains you to accept risk and to endure setbacks. By embracing it, you can enhance your life; but it will also pull you through those painful, frightening, everyday battles we all have to face at one time or another."

Are you pushing yourself to be all that you can be? Don't settle for average. Be a competitor and reach for greatness.